

A Choice That Has a Cost: Outside Pressure

有代价的选择：外部压力

Theme: 心理、决策、责任与人生选择 · New: 44 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 44/6,127

English Story

The outside pressure arrived as a **call** from the publisher's **receptionist**, on an **occasion** that nobody had marked in advance: the whole archive would be printed, or the contract would **cease**. "**Whatever** we do, the **outcome** is the same," the director said. "We have **barely** three weeks, and the **topic** is not ours alone."

The **hesitant** answer was to renovate the old chapters **temporarily** and publish them **afterward**. "Do it **beforehand**," the **receptionist** said. "A **sudden blessing** is still a **blessing**." Somewhere in the building a printer started, and the **hurry** became real.

The **loyal** reader, the **shy** volunteer, and the **inspirational** teacher were the only people who could check the whole series. "A **worthless** paragraph is worse than a missing one," Maya wrote. "A **miraculous** figure is usually a **deficient** one."

The **instinctive** reaction of the group was to glance at the **mode** of the distribution and stop there. "A **holy** number and a **momentary** one look alike on a page," the auditor said. "The **pronoun** in the sentence tells you who is responsible, and the verb tells you when."

The **thirst** for a clean ending was strong, and the ending would not be clean. "A **virtuous** account and a **sacrificial** one are different kinds of writing," Lin said. "One costs money; the other costs somebody."

The pressure produced a decision that was neither heroic nor **worthless**: an **hourly** check for three weeks, a temporary revision, and a promise that the next edition would carry everything. **Whenever** the group published one page, the editor asked for **another**, and the work never **once** became easy. Although we believe in the build, the effect of everything else is too hard to measure. He himself shall feel the pressure, and she should, too. Therefore we shall try to bring the whole record to the press, and the important thing is the life of the reader rather than the life of the author. It was upon this page that the two friends agreed, and it is to this page that the archive returns. The hard part is not the printing; it is the choosing, and everything else is a matter of time. We want to say, before anything else, that we have tried ever since: somehow, anywhere, sometime, we scarcely had a saying in it, and no guarantee whatsoever, because the deadline was not ours to move. There was no bridge chapter left to write, and that, too, was a fact they had to publish.

中文翻译

外部压力以一个电话的形式到来，来自出版社的前台，而这是一个没人提前标记过的场合：要么整份档案付印，要么合同终止。“无论我们怎么做，结果都一样，”主管说，“我们只剩不到三周，而这个话题不只是我们的。”

迟疑的答案是先把旧章节临时翻新，之后再出版。“那就提前做，”前台说，“突如其来的祝福仍然是祝福。”大楼里某处一台打印机启动了，而匆忙变成了真的。

那位忠诚的读者、那位害羞的志愿者和那位鼓舞人心的老师，是唯一能通查整个系列的人。“一段没有价值的段落比一段缺失的段落更糟，”曼雅写道，“一个奇迹般的数字通常是一个有缺陷的数字。”

小组的本能反应是瞥一眼分布的模式然后就停下。“一个神圣的数字和一个瞬间的数字在一页纸上看起来一样，”审计员说，“句子里的代词告诉你谁该负责，动词告诉你什么时候。”

对于干净结局的渴望很强烈，而结局不会是干净的。“一份品德高尚的记述和一份牺牲式的记述是两种不同的写作，”林伟说，“一种花的是钱；另一种花的是某个人。”

压力促成了一项既不英勇也不无价值的决定：连续三周每小时核对、一次临时修订，以及一个承诺——下一版会带上全部内容。每当小组公布一页，编辑就再要一页，而这份工作一次也没有变得容易。虽然我们相信这次建构，但其他一切的效果都太难衡量。他自己将要感受那股压力，她也应当如此。因此我们将试着把整份记录送到印刷厂，而要紧的是读者的生命，而不是作者的生命。两位朋友正是在这一页上达成了一致，而档案也回到这一页。困难的部分不是印刷，而是选择，其余的一切都只是时间问题。我们想在任何事之前先说一句：我们此后一直在尝试：不知怎么，无论在何处，总在某个时候，我们几乎说不上话，也毫无任何保证，因为那个期限不是我们能挪动的。已经没有一座“桥”的章节可写了，而这一点，也是他们必须公布的事实。

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
want wɒnt POS: n	n. 需要的东西, 缺乏, 贫困, 需要; vt. 要, 希望, 应该, 缺少; vi. 生活困苦, 需要, 缺少 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. have need of; v. hunt or look for; want for a particular reason; v. wish or demand the presence of; v. be wit...
call kɔ:l POS: n	n. 呼叫, 访问, 打电话, 号召, 召集, 要求; vt. 呼叫, 召集, 打电话; vi. 叫喊, 访问, 叫牌; [计] 调用; 呼叫; ... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a telephone connection; n. a special disposition (as if from a divine source) to pursue a particular course...
another ə'nʌðə POS: a	a. 另外的, 再一的, 不同的; pron. 又一个, 另一个, 类似的另一个 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. any of various alternatives; some other
before bɪ'fɔ: POS: prep	prep. 在...之前; conj. 在...之前; adv. 在前 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r earlier in time; previously; r at or in the front
ever 'evə POS: adv	adv. 曾经, 究竟, 永远 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. at any time; r. (intensifier for adjectives) very
once wʌns POS: adv	adv. 一次, 曾经, 一旦; conj. 一旦, 一经; n. 一次; a. 从前的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. on one occasion; r. as soon as; r. at a previous time;
whatever hwɒt'evə POS: pron	pron. 无论什么 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s one or some or every or all without specification
occasion ə'keɪʒən POS: n	n. 场合, 时机, 机会, 诱因, 理由; vt. 惹起, 引起 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. reason; n. the time of a particular event; n. an opportunity to do something; v. give occasion to
somehow 'sʌmhaʊ POS: adv	adv. 不知何故 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. in some unspecified way or manner; or by some unspecified means; r. for some unspecified reason;
outcome 'aʊtkʌm POS: n	n. 结果, 出口 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n something that results; n a phenomenon that follows and is caused by some previous phenomenon
topic 'tɒpɪk POS: n	n. 主题, 论题, 话题 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. some situation or event that is thought about
anywhere 'enihwɛə POS: adv	adv. 无论何处 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. at or in or to any place; ('anyplace' is used informally for 'anywhere')
barely 'beəli POS: adv	adv. 几乎不 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. only a very short time before
glance 'glɑ:ns POS: n	n. 一瞥, 闪光, 掠过, 辉矿类; vi. 扫视, 闪光, 掠过, 提到, 略说; vt. 扫视, 反射, 使掠过 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a quick look; v. throw a glance at; take a brief look at; v. hit at an angle
mode məʊd POS: n	n. 模式, 调式, 样式, 文体, 状态, 方式, 风尚; [计] 方式; DOS外部命令:设定各种设备命令 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a particular functioning condition or arrangement; n. any of various fixed orders of the various diatonic n...
sudden 'sʌdn POS: n	n. 突然, 忽然; a. 突然的, 意外的, 快速的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. happening without warning or in a short space of time
whenever hwen'eve POS: conj	conj. 每当; adv. 不论何时, 每逢 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: adv. & conj. At whatever time.
holy 'həʊli POS: a	a. 神圣的, 圣洁的, 至善的; n. 神圣的东西 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. belonging to or derived from or associated with a divine power
cease si:s POS: n	n. 停止; v. 停止, 终了 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. ('cease' is a noun only in the phrase 'without cease') end
hurry 'hʌri POS: n	n. 匆忙, 急忙, 急促; vt. 急派, 催促; vi. 匆忙, 赶快 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a condition of urgency making it necessary to hurry
scarcely 'skɑ:sli POS: adv	adv. 简直不, 一定不, 仅仅 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r only a very short time before; r almost not
afterward 'ɑ:ftəwəd POS: adv	adv. 然后, 后来 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r happening at a time subsequent to a reference time
shy ʃai POS: n	n. 惊跳, 惊避; a. 胆怯的, 畏缩的, 迟疑的, 羞怯的; vi. 惊退, 乱投, 乱掷, 厌恶, 避开; vt. 乱投, 乱掷 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a quick throw; v. start suddenly, as from fright; v. throw quickly; s. short
loyal 'lɔɪəl POS: a	a. 忠诚的, 忠实的, 忠贞的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. steadfast in allegiance or duty

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
blessing 'blesɪŋ POS: n	n. 祝福 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the formal act of approving; n. a desirable state; n. the act of praying for divine protection
temporarily 'tempərəreɪli POS: adv	adv. 暂时, 一时, 临时 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. for a limited time only; not permanently
sometime 'sʌmtaɪn POS: a	a. 以前的, 某一时间的; adv. 改天, 来日 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. at some indefinite or unstated time
whatsoever 'hwɒtsəʊ'evə POS: pron	pron. 无论什么 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s one or some or every or all without specification
saying 'seɪɪŋ POS: n	n. 叙述, 话, 说, 言论 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a word or phrase that particular people use in particular situations
beforehand bɪ'fɔ:hænd POS: adv	adv. 预先 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s being ahead of time or need; r ahead of time; in anticipation
renovate 'renəʊveɪt POS: vt	vt. 更新, 革新, 刷新, 修复, 使恢复活力 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. restore to a previous or better condition
instinctive ɪn'stɪŋktɪv POS: a	a. 本能的, 天生的, 直觉的; [医] 本能的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s unthinking; prompted by (or as if by) instinct
worthless 'wɜ:θlɪs POS: a	a. 无价值的, 无益的, 无足轻重的; [法] 无价值的, 无用的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. lacking in usefulness or value
receptionist rɪ'sepʃənɪst POS: n	n. 接待员 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a secretary whose main duty is to answer the telephone and receive visitors
miraculous mɪ'rækjələs POS: a	a. 奇迹的, 不可思议的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s being or having the character of a miracle; s peculiarly fortunate or appropriate; as if by divine intervention...
pronoun 'prəʊnaʊn POS: n	n. 代词 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a function word that is used in place of a noun or noun phrase
hesitant 'hezɪtənt POS: a	a. 迟疑的, 踌躇的, 犹豫不定的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. lacking decisiveness of character; unable to act or decide quickly or firmly
thirst θɜ:st POS: n	n. 口渴, 渴望; vi. 口渴, 渴望 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a physiological need to drink; v. feel the need to drink
inspirational ˌɪnspə'reɪʃənəl POS: a	a. 凭灵感的, 鼓舞人心的, 神感的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. imparting a divine influence on the mind and soul
deficient dɪ'fɪʃənt POS: a	a. 不足的, 不充分的, 有缺陷的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. inadequate in amount or degree; s. falling short of some prescribed norm
hourly 'aʊəli POS: a	a. 每小时的, 以小时计的, 频繁的; adv. 每小时地, 频繁地, 不绝地 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. occurring every hour or payable by the hour; r. every hour; by the hour
momentary 'məʊməntəri POS: a	a. 瞬间的, 刹那间的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s lasting for a markedly brief time
virtuous 'vɜ:tʃuəs POS: a	a. 品德高尚的, 公正的, 贞洁的, 有效力的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. morally excellent
sacrificial 'sækrɪ'fɪʃəl POS: a	a. 牺牲的, 献祭的, 亏本的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. used in or connected with a sacrifice